

1. Qwen3.8-Flash-Next

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-26T23:52:58+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Aug/26/qwen38-flash-next/>

Qwen3.8-Flash-Next Another open weights model from Qwen. This one is "a multimodal MoE model that also serves as an early preview of the architecture used in Qwen4". It's pretty big: 125B tokens, but only 6B active which means it gets a significant performance boost. I've been trying it out on a DGX Spark using these Unsloth quantized models . I'm still exploring the model - so far I've tried the 72.5GB UD-IQ1_S one (producing these pelicans) and the 78.9GB UD-Q2_K_XL (producing these). My favorite so far was this xhigh reasoning effort one from UD-Q2_K_XL: Via Hacker News Tags: ai , generative-ai , llms , qwen , pelican-riding-a-bicycle , ai-in-china , nvidia-spark

2. Quoting Paul Dix

Source: Simon Willison's Weblog | Published: 2026-08-26T08:07:55+00:00

Link: <https://simonwillison.net/2026/Aug/26/paul-dix/>

The fact that AI wrote 1M LOC and then refined it over the course of the next couple of months to produce a reliable piece of software that is currently running on millions of developer machines is absolutely mind blowing. And you can say, "well it's not that impressive because they had an oracle to compare against, so it was simple to go from one language to another?", but I think that's selling this entire thing short. If you can build a verification system and give proper direction, AI can produce a highly complex, highly sophisticated piece of software and it can continue to refine it until it just works. ? Paul Dix , The end of programming Tags: coding-agents , ai-assisted-programming , generative-ai , bun , ai , llms

3. POSIWID: The Purpose of a System Is What It Does

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-26T20:18:04Z

Link: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/The_purpose_of_a_system_is_what_it_does

Wikipedia: The purpose of a system is what it does (POSIWID) is a heuristic in systems thinking coined by the British management consultant Stafford Beer , who stated that there is "no point in claiming that the purpose of a system is to do what it constantly fails to do". It is used in systems theory, and is generally invoked to counter the notion that the purpose of a system can or should be read from the intentions of those who design, operate, or promote it. When a system's side effects or unintended consequences reveal that its behaviour is poorly understood, then the POSIWID perspective can balance political understandings of system behaviour with a more straightforwardly descriptive view. I don't recall seeing POSIWID before, but I love the concept. A friend sent this to me, with the quip that I forgot to include a link to it in my "What Is the Point of the DMA?" piece this week. Indeed, it encapsulates my arguments about the DMA specifically and the European Commission generally. The purpose the DMA is what it does, not what you imagine it is intended to do. In the same vein, I have been thinking too about the famous anecdote reported by Adam Lashinsky for Fortune back i...

4. Apple's Polishing Cloth Is Now Just \$9

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-26T19:18:40Z

Link: <https://9to5mac.com/2026/08/25/apple-releases-new-polishing-cloth-for-9/>

Chance Miller: Not to be overshadowed by the new Mac mini and Mac Studio , Apple today has also released an updated version of its Polishing Cloth. In an age of everything getting more expensive, the new Polishing Cloth is cheaper than before at \$9 (down from \$19). [...] Apple released the Polishing Cloth in October 2021 and sold out almost instantly. While it has become a meme, it is genuinely a good polishing cloth for your Apple gear. Moore's Law comes for everything eventually. ?

5. "Surprise and Shine" Apple Event: Wednesday 9 September

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-08-26T19:16:34Z

Link: <https://9to5mac.com/2026/08/26/apple-officially-announces-iphone-18-pro-foldable-event/>

Zac Hall, 9to5Mac: Apple has officially announced its next product event, where it will unveil the iPhone 18 Pro lineup and its first foldable iPhone. The event will take place on September 9 at 10 am, PT. The tagline reads "Surprise and shine," and the invitation features a glowing Apple logo with a sun shining through. Apple generally prefers Tuesdays, but on years when Labor Day falls in the second week of September, they move it to Wednesday. "

6. Why didn't the Windows Entertainment Pack just run the MS-DOS version inside an emulator?

Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Tue, 25 Aug 2026 14:00:00 +0000

Link: <https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20260825-00/?p=112645>

It wouldn't be a Windows Entertainment Pack then, would it? The post Why didn't the Windows Entertainment Pack just run the MS-DOS version inside an emulator? appeared first on The Old New Thing .

7. What is the quality of software that AI writes?

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Wed, 26 Aug 2026 18:51:13 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/08/26/what-is-the-quality-of-software-that-ai-writes/>

AI-powered coding agents increase productivity for many developers. But do these agents produce good-quality code? Some say this doesn't matter, we are heading toward dark software factories with source code never inspected, and maybe we should eliminate source code altogether??source code is the new assembly code?. Others have a different view. Humans sometimes need to [?] The post What is the quality of software that AI writes? first appeared on John D. Cook .

8. Junk solutions

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Wed, 26 Aug 2026 12:16:17 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/08/26/junk-solutions/>

When you're interested in studying a family of functions, it can be useful to look at a differential equation that the functions solve. This is a theme I've written about several times, most recently here and here, but also three years ago here. Orthogonal polynomials are mathematically elegant as well as very useful in applications [1]. [?] The post Junk solutions first appeared on John D. Cook .

9. Ultraspherical

Source: John D. Cook | Published: Wed, 26 Aug 2026 10:51:32 +0000

Link: <https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/08/26/ultraspherical/>

When I hear the term ultraspherical I think of something extremely spherical. For example, a baseball is spherical, but a billiard ball is more spherical. Maybe a highly polished billiard ball is ultraspherical. Using this line of thought, the term ultraspherical polynomial is inexplicable. This is an example of the arcane terminology I wrote about recently. In [?] The post Ultraspherical first appeared on John D. Cook .

10. If your VS Code remotes stopped working, downgrade to v1.124.x

Source: Xe Iaso's blog | Published: Wed, 26 Aug 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://xeiaso.net/notes/2026/vscode-remotes-not-working-downgrade/>

Quality software reigns again

11. How to make VS Code go back to the old UI

Source: Xe Iaso's blog | Published: Wed, 26 Aug 2026 00:00:00 GMT

Link: <https://xeiaso.net/notes/2026/vscode-ui-revert/>

What do you wanna bet someone's gonna get promoted for deleting this workaround from the code?

12. Gadget Review: Thermal Master P3 Macro Lens ?????

Source: Terence Eden's Blog | Published: Wed, 26 Aug 2026 11:34:52 +0000

Link: <https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/08/gadget-review-thermal-master-p3-macro-lens/>

The good folks at Thermal Master have sent me their latest camera to review - and it is a bit different to all the others I've tried. Whereas previous cameras are good for bird watching, or wildlife spotting, or finding leaks at home - the P3 has a manual macro lens and is specifically designed for getting close-up and personal with your electronics. Yup! See just how hot your CPU is getting?

13. Futurism Is Always Extreme

Source: Fernando Borretti | Published: Wed, 26 Aug 2026 00:00:00 +1000

Link: <https://borretti.me/article/futurism-is-always-extreme>

Rigorous thinking about the future produces extreme outcomes.

14. Can Self-Hosting Be Simple?

Source: Tedium: The Dull Side of the Internet. | Published: 2026-08-27T03:11:28Z

Link: <https://feed.tedium.co/link/15204/17432610/self-hosting-third-place-strategy>

You can go into the deep end way too easily with a self-hosting project. But is a less-is-more approach possible? Here's what my attempt to build a 'third-place' box taught me.

15. Pluralistic: The age of disinvention (25 Aug 2026)

Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Wed, 26 Aug 2026 03:21:38 +0000

Link: <https://pluralistic.net/2026/08/25/gammamax/>

Today's links The age of disinvention:

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this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: Metacrap; CmdrTaco retires; Chalk memorial for Jack Layton; By all means tread on these people. Upcoming appearances: Sydney, Melbourne, Brighton, London, South Bend. Recent appearances: Where I've been. Latest books: You keep readin' em, I'll keep writin' 'em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I'll keep writin' 'em.

Colophon: All the rest. The age of disinvention (permalink) They disinvented the VCR. You might think that the reason we don't have VCRs anymore is because VCRs were supplanted by DVDs, PVRs and streaming, but that's not the case. They had it in for the VCR from the very start, and they never stopped trying to kill it. Eventually, they succeeded. The VCR was one of the fastest-adopted technologies in the history of the world, and it was disruptive. The fact that you could record shows to watch later, skip the ads, build a library of your favorites, even loan your tapes around ? it drove the studios and broadcasters nuts. The VCR hit the market under a cloud of litigation, and the lawsuits went al...